

"This," "that," "these," and "those" can be used as determiners before a noun to specify which noun is being talked about. They can also be used as pronouns to replace a noun in a sentence.

See also:

 Singular and plural nouns **69**

 Personal pronouns **77** Possession **80**

65.1 "THIS" AND "THAT" AS DETERMINERS

"This" and "that" are only used with singular nouns. "This" is used for something close, and "that" for something farther away.



This house is too big.

↖ The house is close to you.



That house is too small.

↖ The house is farther away from you.



This job is great.

↖ "This" refers to the job that the speaker is currently doing.



That job was boring.

↖ "That" refers to a job in the past that isn't being done anymore.

↖ "Was" is in the past tense.

"This" can also be used for something current or present, and "that" can be used for something absent or in the past.

FURTHER EXAMPLES



This essay is proving to be really difficult.



That cake in the window looks incredible.



I like **this** rabbit so much I want to take it home.



I'd like to see **that** play this weekend.



When I eat out I always order **this** rice dish.



This show is great, but I didn't like **that** other show as much.

↖ Uncountable nouns are only used with "this" and "that," never "these" and "those."

↖ "Other" can be used after "that" to stress that it is different to the first noun.